STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Org Chart Builder

How to look up people, keep the organizational chart up to date, and share it — explained one click at a time. No technical knowledge needed.

What's in this guide

1. Before you start (read this!)
2. Opening the Org Chart Builder
3. What you see on the screen
4. Finding a person
5. Moving around a page
6. Seeing someone's details
7. Turning on Edit
8. Changing a title, name or department
9. Moving someone to a new manager
10. Oops! Undoing a mistake
11. Adding a new person
12. When someone leaves
13. The People list
14. Making it official (Publish)
15. Printing or saving a PDF
16. Sharing the chart with everyone
17. Rearranging or hiding pages
18. Something looks wrong? (Help)
19. One-page cheat sheet

1 Before you start

Three things that make this easy.

You can't break it.
Every change can be undone. The chart also keeps automatic backups.

There is no Save button.
Changes save by themselves the moment you make them.

Looking is always safe.
Nothing can change until you switch to **Edit**.

About the pictures in this guide
They show a made-up company called “Sample Credit Union”. Your screen will show your own organization, but every button is in the same place. The 1 2 3 yellow numbers in the pictures match the numbers in the text.

2 Opening the Org Chart Builder

Look for this icon on your desktop:

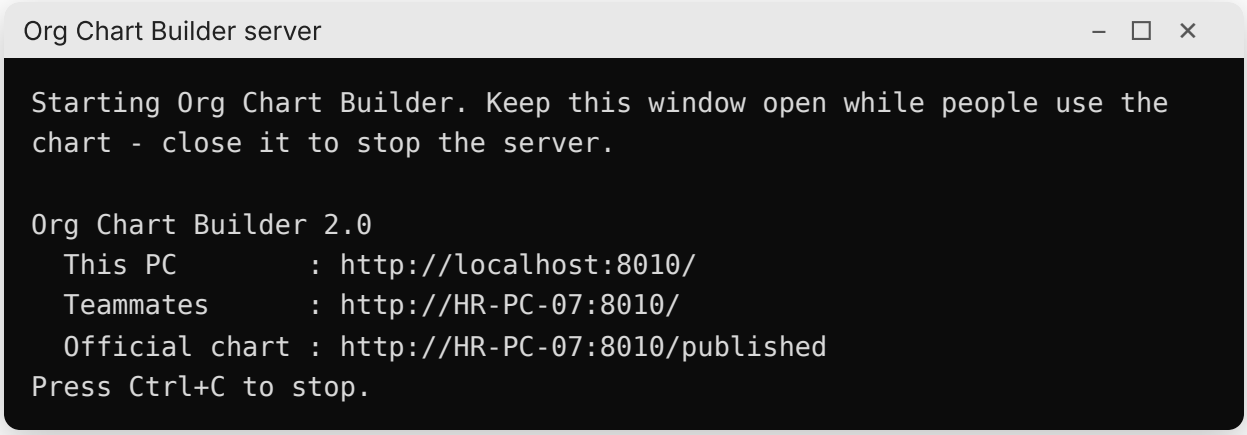


Org Chart Builder

1. **Double-click** the **Org Chart Builder** icon on your desktop.
2. The Org Chart Builder opens in its own window. That's it!

If you are the person who “hosts” the chart

One computer runs the Org Chart Builder for everybody. If that's your computer, double-clicking the icon also opens a **black window** like this one:



✕ **Leave the black window open.**
It's what makes the chart work for everyone. You can make it smaller with the **–** button in its top-right corner, but **don't close it** with ✕. If it gets closed, just double-click the desktop icon again.

i **Turned the computer off?**
No problem. After you turn it back on, double-click the icon once to start everything again. Nothing is lost.

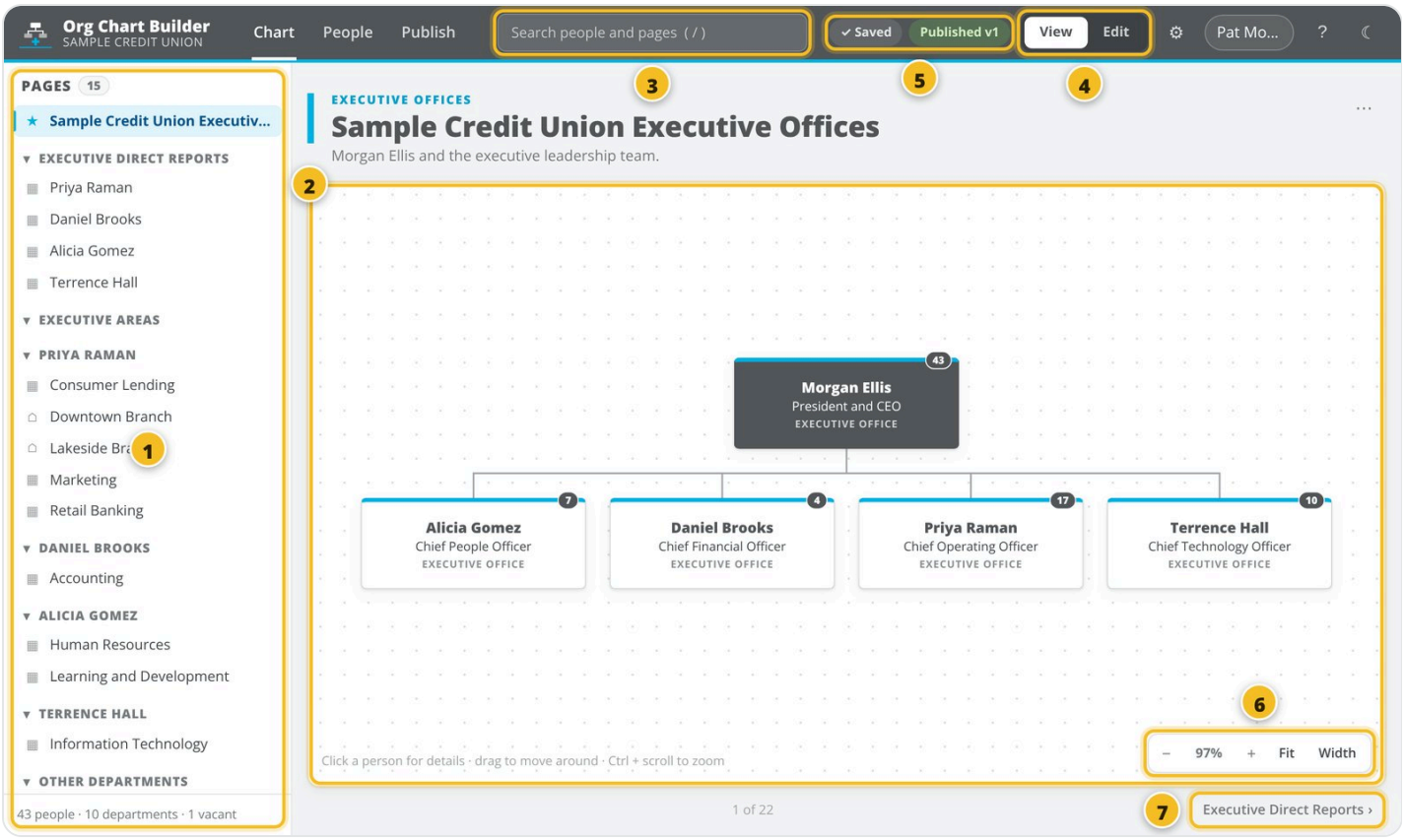
Don't have the icon yet? (one-time setup)

1. Open the **Org Chart Builder** folder (ask your coordinator where it is).
2. Double-click **Install_Desktop_Shortcut**.
3. A window asks a question:
   - Type `1` and press `Enter` if **your** computer is the host.
   - Type `2` and press `Enter` if someone else's computer is the host. Then type the address they give you (it looks like **http://HR-PC-07:8010/**) and press `Enter`.
4. The icon appears on your desktop.

> **The first time you change something**
> you'll be asked for your name. Type it and click `Continue`. This is how the chart remembers who made each change.

3 What you see on the screen

The screen has the same few parts every time.

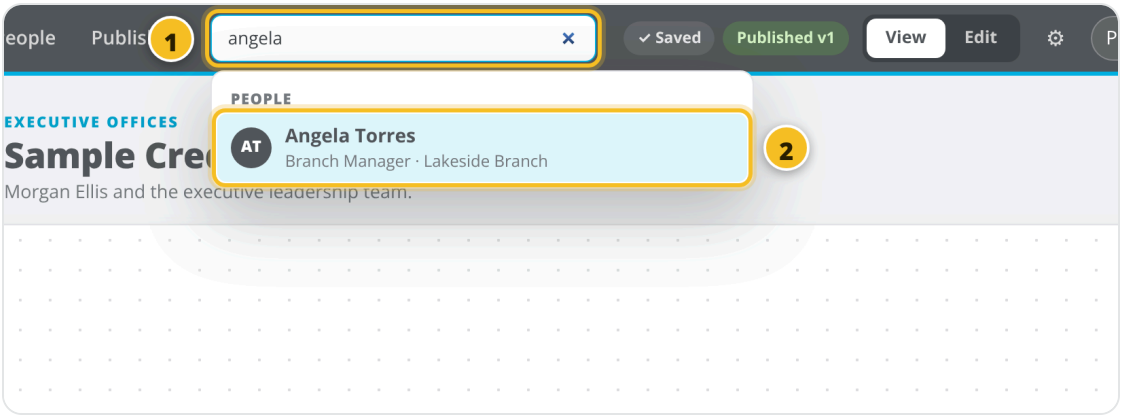


1. **Page list.** Every page of the chart. Click a name to open that page.
2. **The chart.** The page you are looking at.
3. **Search.** Type a name to find someone fast.
4. **View / Edit.** View is for looking. Edit is for making changes.
5. **Status.** "✓ Saved" means your work is safe. More about the yellow "Draft" label in section 14.
6. **Zoom.** Make the chart bigger or smaller.
7. **Next page.** Go to the next page (the arrow on the left goes back).

> **The tabs at the very top**
> **Chart** shows the pictures, **People** shows everyone as a list, and **Publish** is where you make the chart official and get printouts.

4 Finding a person

1. Click in the **Search** box at the top (1).
2. Type part of their name (for example *angela*). You can also type a job title or a department.
3. Click the person in the list that drops down (2).

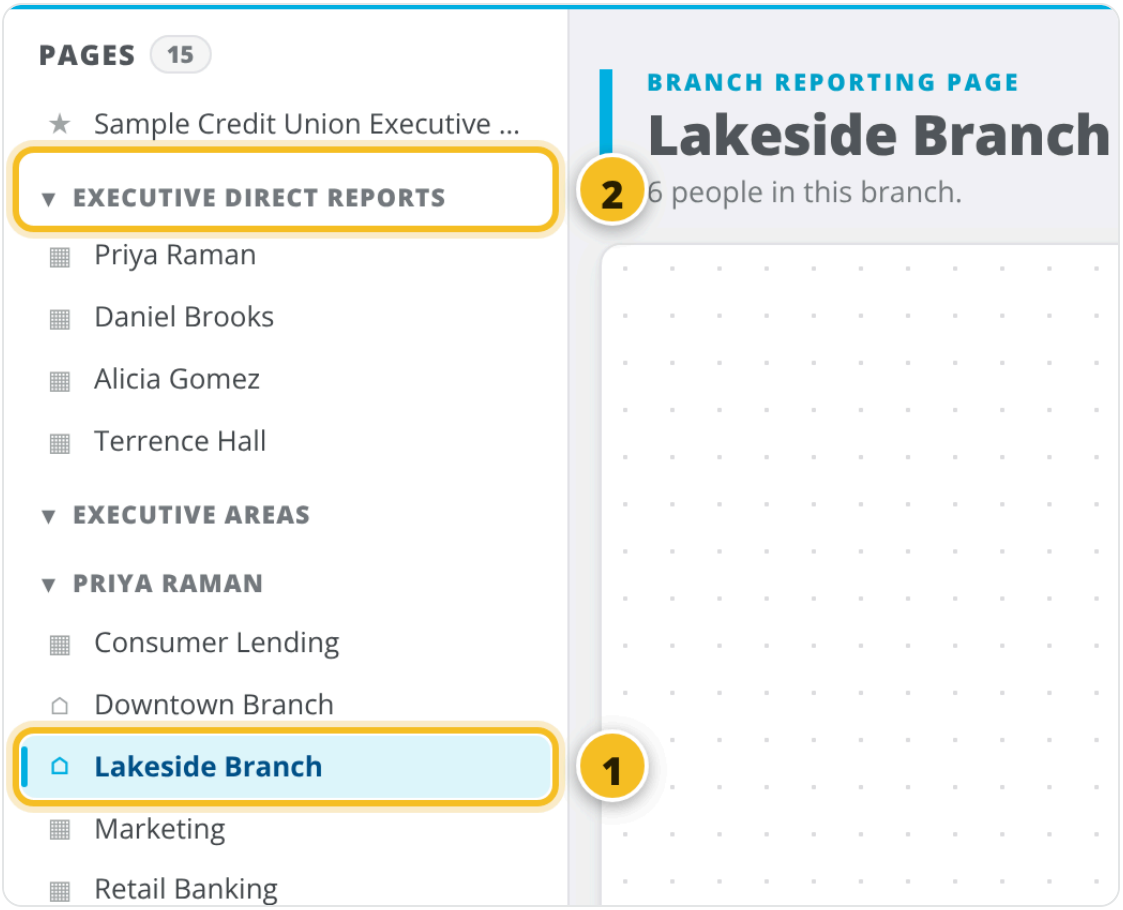


The chart jumps to the right page and the person's card **flashes yellow**. Their details open on the right (see section 6).

5 Moving around a page

Going to another page

Click a page name in the **page list** on the left (1). The page you are on is highlighted in blue. The headings in capital letters (2) are groups. Click a heading to fold it away or open it again.

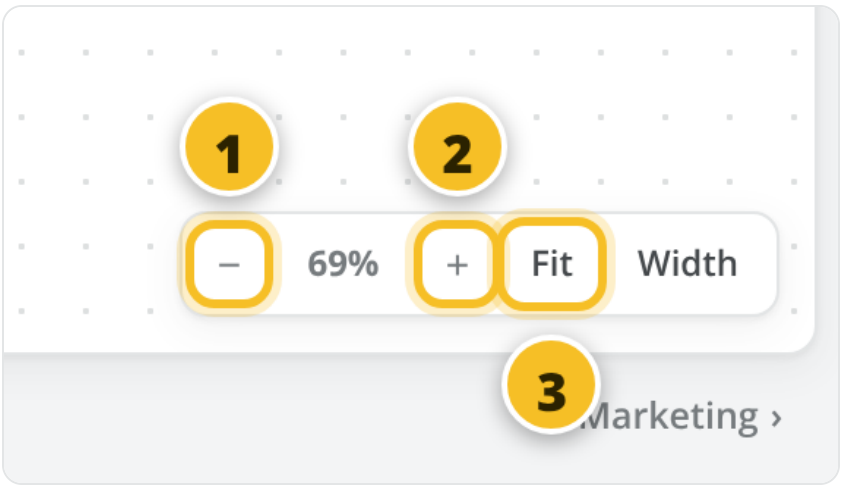


Moving the chart around

Big departments don't fit on the screen. To see the rest:

- **Click on an empty spot** of the chart (not on a person), **hold the mouse button down** and **drag**. The chart moves with your mouse.
- Or just **scroll** with your mouse wheel or touchpad.

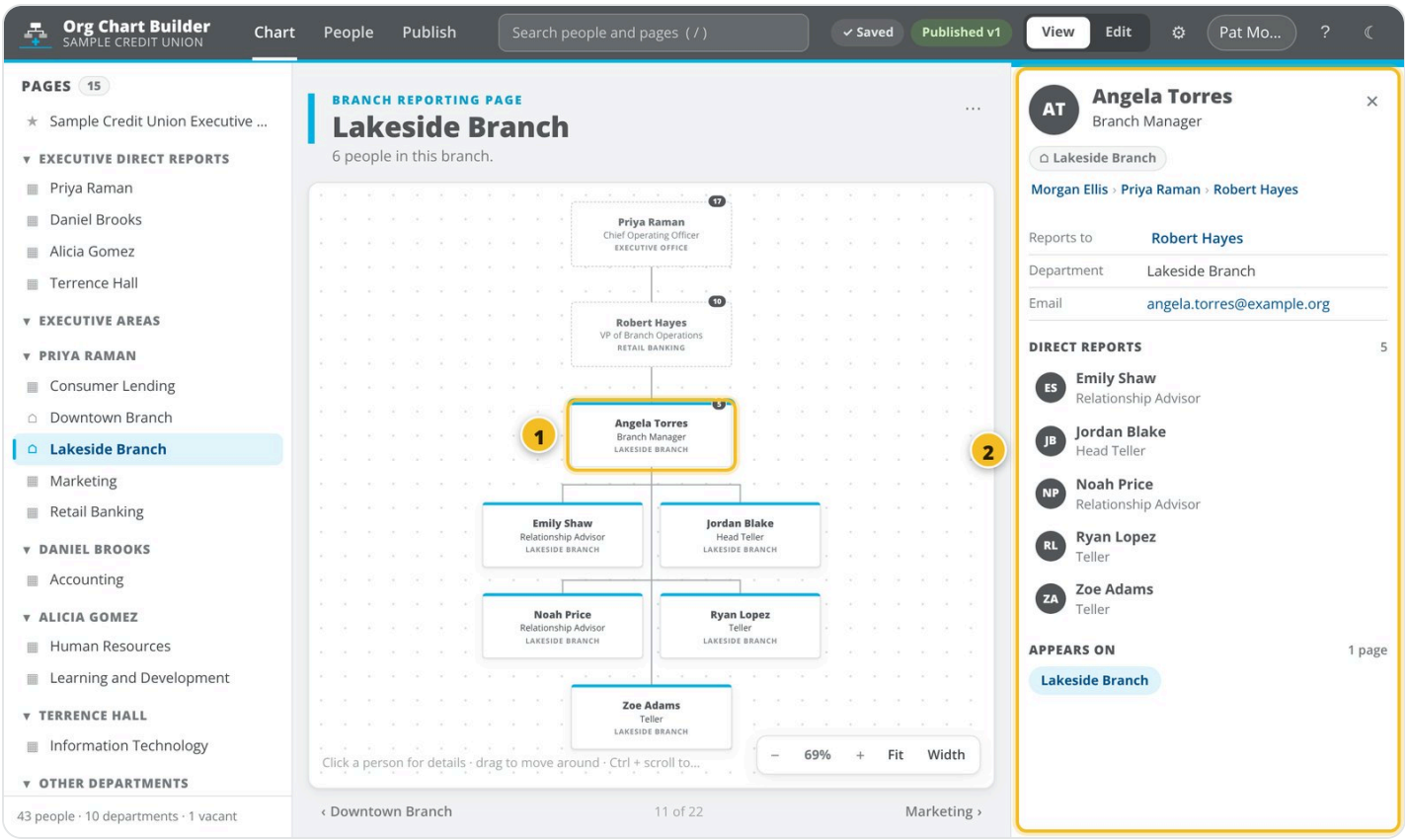
Making it bigger or smaller



1. **–** makes it smaller.
2. **+** makes it bigger.
3. **Fit** shows the whole page at once.
4. Lost? Click **Fit** and you're back to the whole page.

6 Seeing someone's details

1. **Click a person's card** (1).
2. A panel opens on the right (2). It shows their manager, department, email, and the people who report to them.
3. Click any blue name in the panel to jump to that person.
4. To close the panel, click the ✕ in its top-right corner (or press **Esc**).



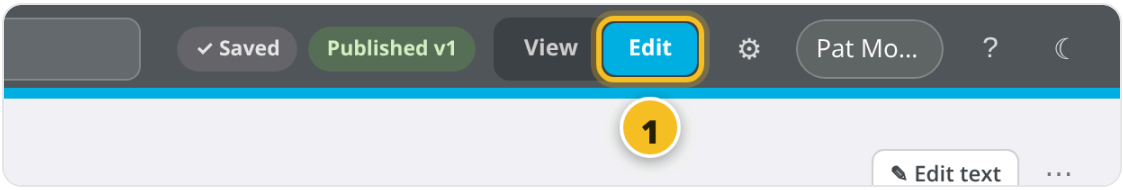
What the small things on a card mean

The dark number in the corner is how many people work under that person, in total. **Dashed, grey cards** are managers shown for context; they belong to another department. A **"Vacant"** card is an open position. If you see a **+3** button under a card, some people are folded away. Click it to show them.

7 Turning on Edit

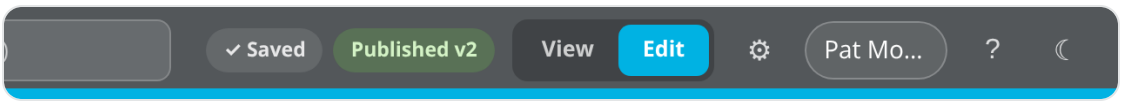
You can't change anything by accident. Changes only work after you switch to Edit.

1. Click **Edit** at the top right (1). It turns blue.
2. The first time, type your name and click **Continue**.
3. When you're finished, click **View** to go back to look-only mode.



How do I know my change is saved?

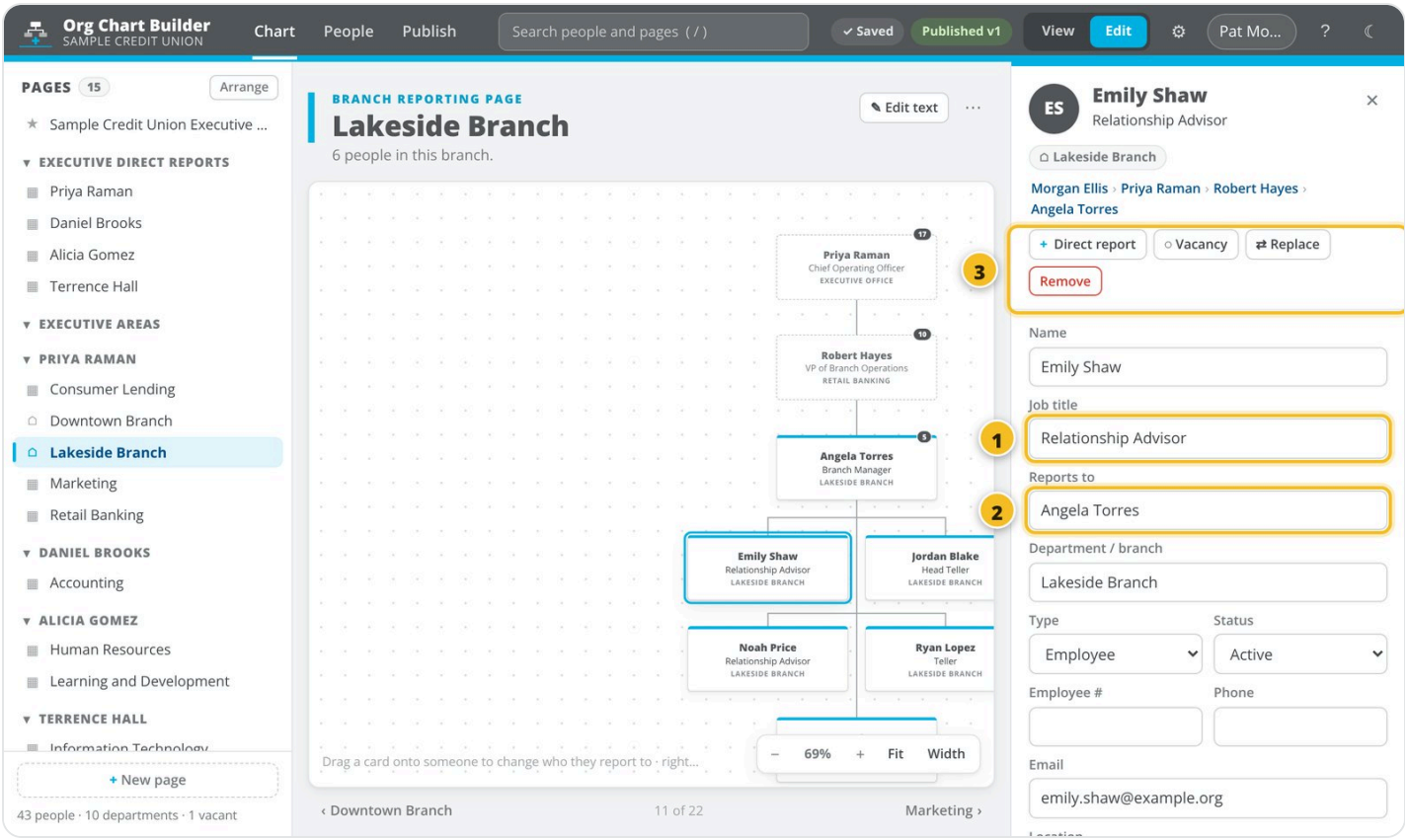
Look at the top of the screen. **"✓ Saved"** means your change is safe. You don't need to do anything else.



Several people can edit at the same time.
When a colleague changes something, it shows up on your screen within a few seconds. You may see a message like "Updated with Pat's changes". That's normal.

8 Changing a title, name or department

1. Make sure **Edit** is on.
2. **Click the person's card.** The panel on the right now shows boxes you can type in.
3. **Click in the box** you want to change, for example **Job title** (1).
4. Type the new text and press **Enter**. Done! The card on the chart changes right away.



The **Reports to** box (2) changes who the person's manager is. Click it, type the manager's name, and click the right person in the list.

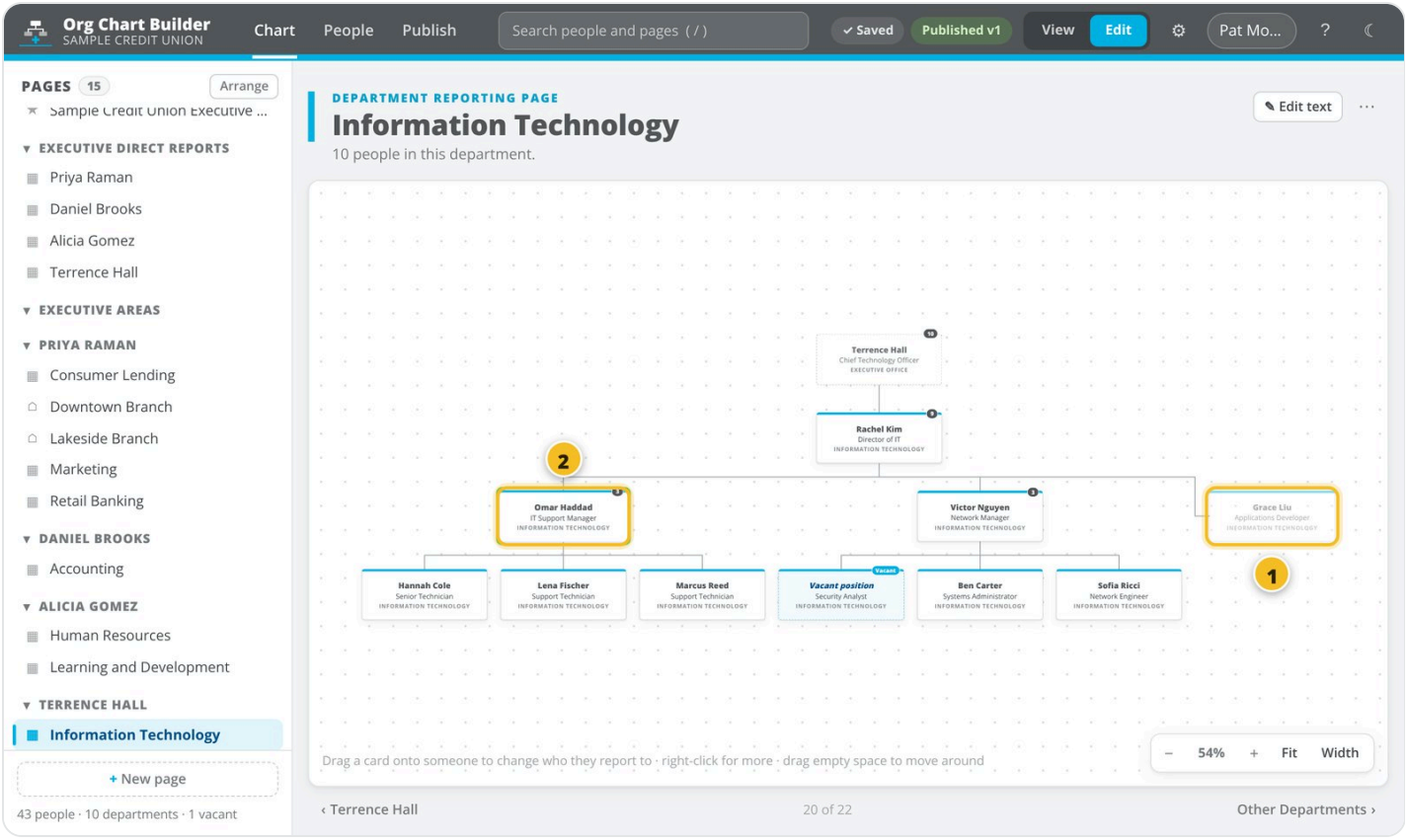
The buttons at the top of the panel (3) do the bigger jobs: adding someone under this person, adding a vacancy, replacing them, or removing them. These are explained in the next sections.

9 Moving someone to a new manager

Two ways. Use whichever feels easier.

Way 1: drag and drop

1. Make sure **Edit** is on.
2. Put your mouse on the person's card (1), **press and hold** the mouse button.
3. Drag the card on top of their **new manager's** card (2). It gets a **green outline** when you're in the right spot.
4. **Let go** of the mouse button.



> **Red outline?**
> That move isn't allowed. You can't put a manager underneath someone who already reports to them. Let go anywhere else and nothing changes.

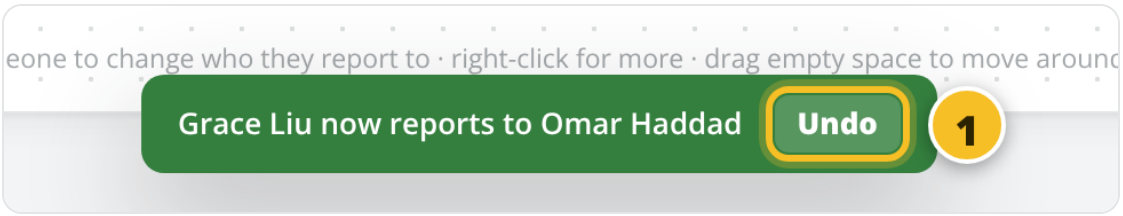
Way 2: type the new manager

Click the person, then change the **Reports to** box in the panel (see section 8).

> **The person disappeared from the page?**
> That's normal if their new manager is in a different department. They now show up on that department's page. Use **Search** to find them.

10 Oops! Undoing a mistake

After most changes, a green message appears at the bottom of the screen with an **Undo** button (1). Click it, and the change is reversed.



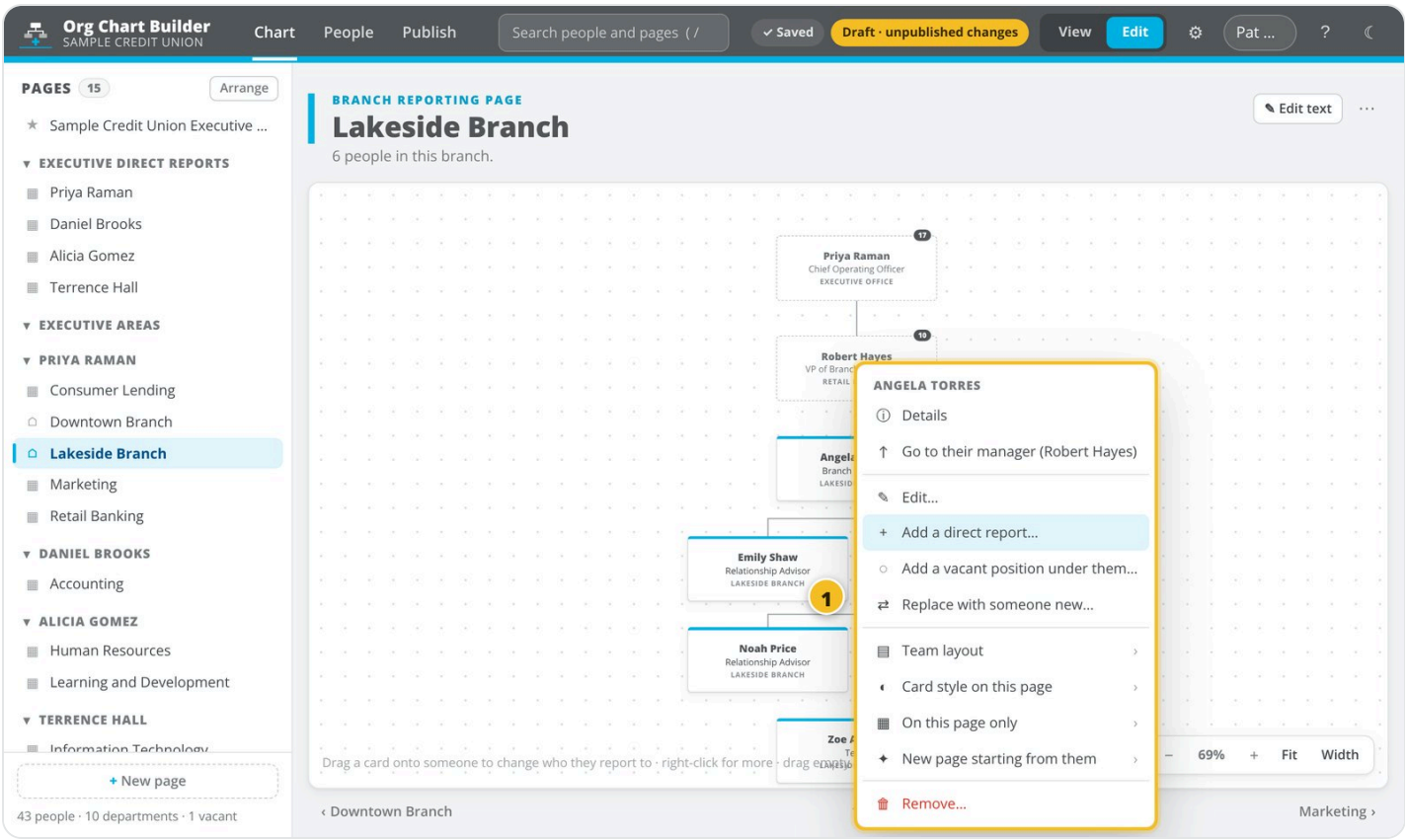
Missed the message? Press Ctrl + Z on your keyboard (hold **Ctrl**, tap **Z**). Press it again to undo the change before that, and so on.

Undid too much? Ctrl + Y puts it back.

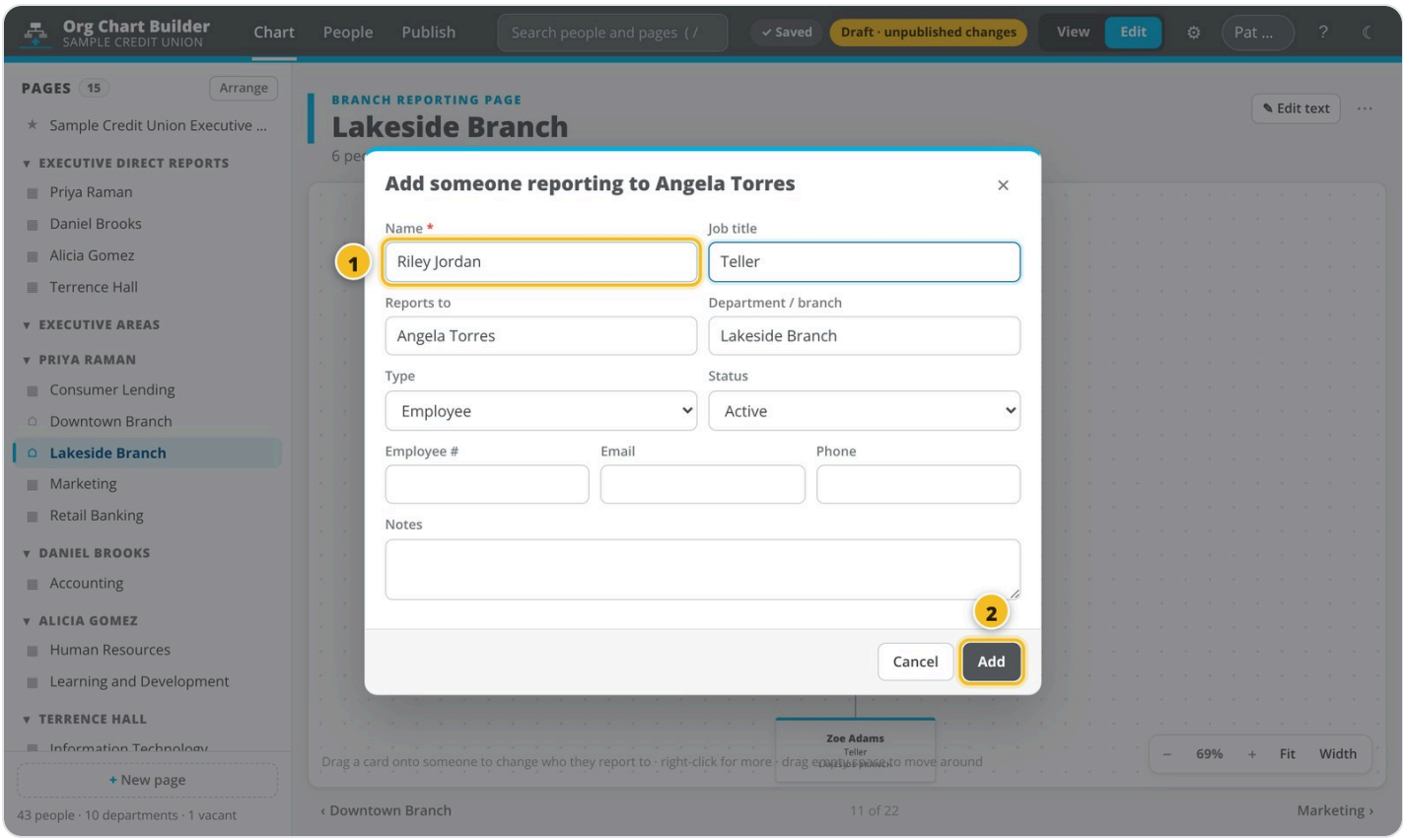
> **Made a mistake days ago?**
> The chart keeps automatic backups. See “I need yesterday's version back” in section 18.

11 Adding a new person

1. Make sure **Edit** is on.
2. Find the new person's **manager** on the chart.
3. **Right-click** the manager's card. That means clicking with the **right** mouse button. A menu opens (1).
4. Click **Add a direct report...**



5. Type the person's **Name** and **Job title** (1). The manager and department are already filled in for you.
6. Click **Add** (2).



The new person appears on the chart, flashing yellow so you can spot them.

> **Other ways to add someone**
> Click a manager and use the **+ Direct report** button in the panel, or go to the **People** tab and click **+ Add person**.

Adding an open (vacant) position

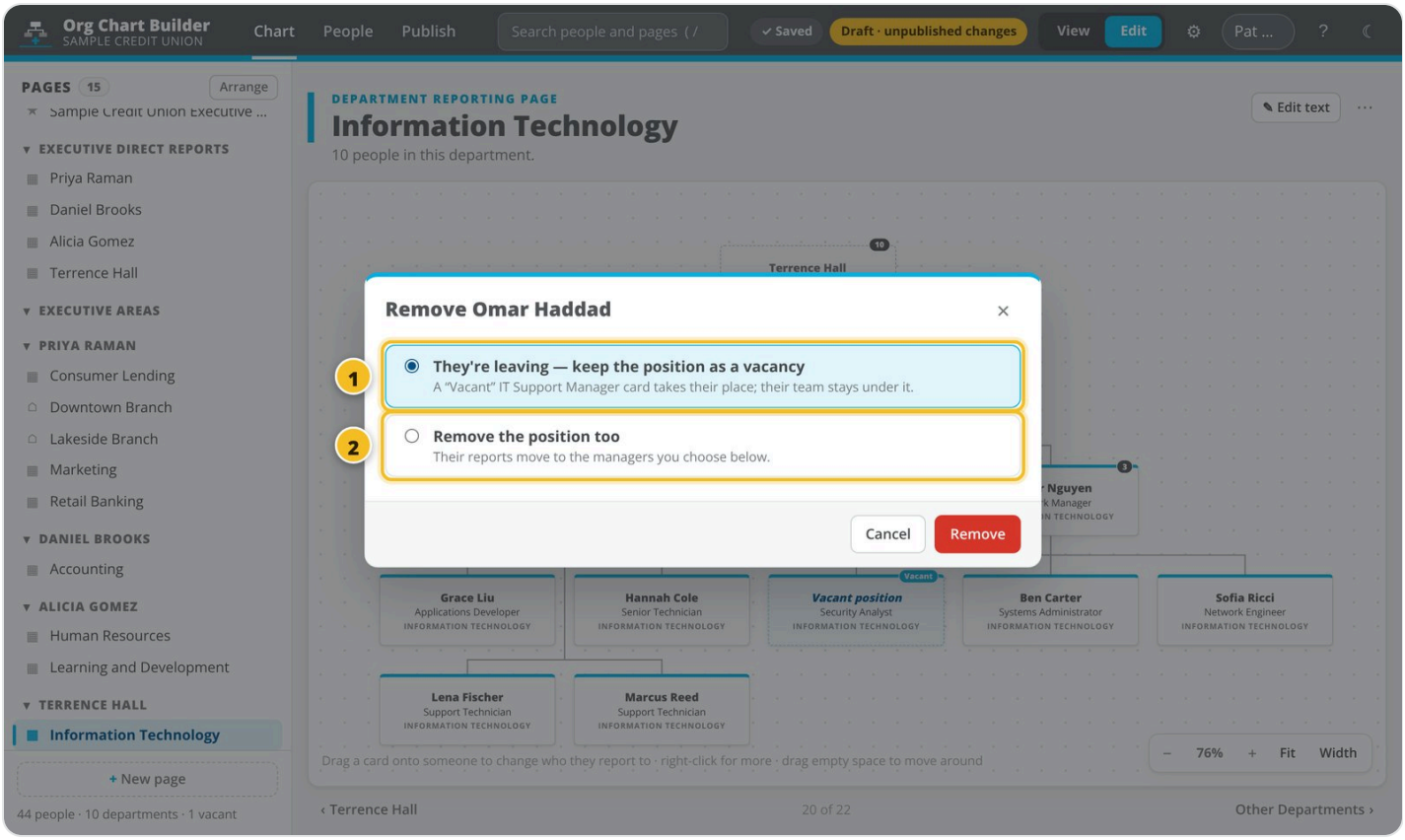
Right-click the manager and choose **Add a vacant position under them...** Leave the name empty, type the job title, and click **Add**.

Someone was hired into a vacancy

Right-click the **Vacant** card, choose **Fill this vacancy...**, type the new person's name and click **Fill position**. Anyone who reported to the vacancy now reports to the new person.

12 When someone leaves

1. Make sure **Edit** is on.
2. Right-click the person's card and choose **Remove…** (or click them and use the red **Remove** button in the panel).
3. Choose what should happen:



1. **"They're leaving — keep the position as a vacancy".** Pick this when the job will be filled again. A "Vacant" card takes their place, and their team stays where it is. *This is usually the right choice.*
2. **"Remove the position too".** Pick this when the job is going away. The window then lists each person who reported to them. Choose a new manager for each one, or use **Apply to all** to give them all the same new manager.
4. Click the red **Remove** button.

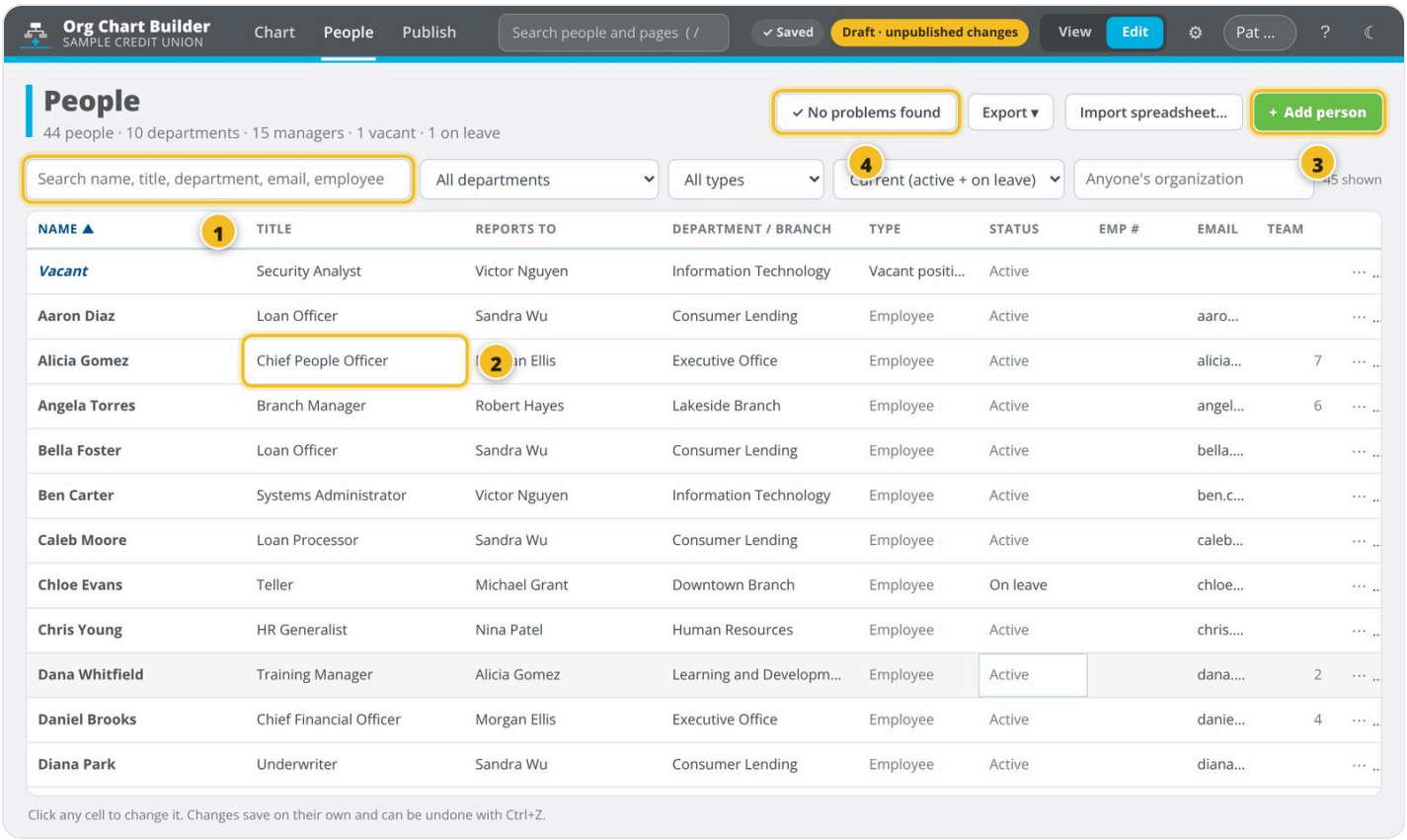
Nothing is truly deleted.
Removed people are kept in the list as “Inactive”, so you can always bring them back. See section 13.

Someone is replaced by a new person

Right-click them and choose **Replace with someone new…** Type the new person's name and click **Replace**. The new person takes over the same title, manager and team.

13 The People list

Click **People** at the top of the screen to see everyone as a list, like a spreadsheet.



1. **Search** the list by name, title, department or email. The menus beside it narrow the list down.
2. In **Edit**, **click any box** to change it. Type, then press **Enter**.
3. **+ Add person** adds someone new.
4. **Things to check** lists possible mistakes, for example two people with the same name, or someone whose manager was removed. Click **Show** next to a problem to see who it's about.

To get the list into **Excel**, click **Export ▾** and choose **Excel workbook (.xlsx)**. The file goes to your **Downloads** folder.

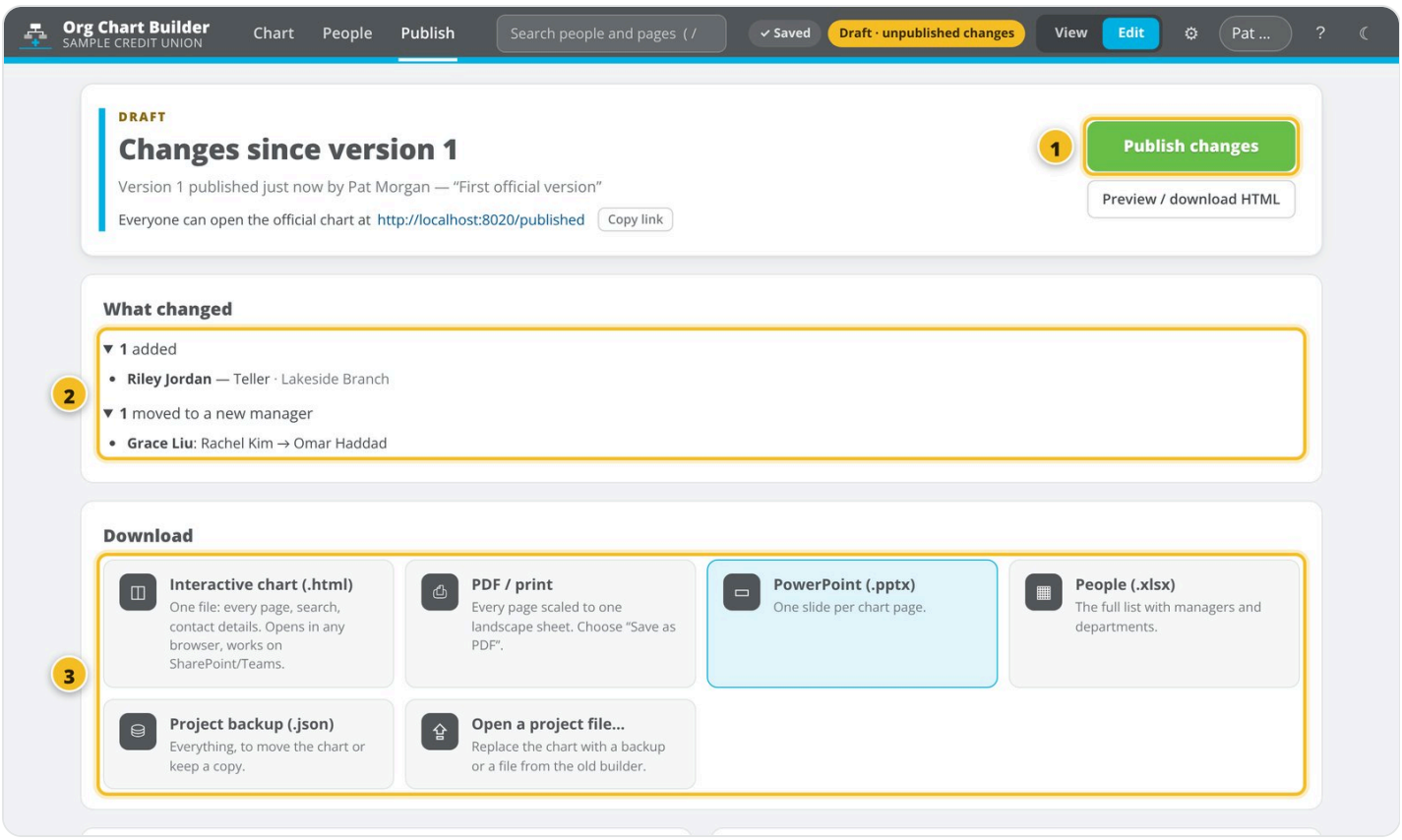
> **Bringing a removed person back**
> With **Edit** on, change the menu that says "Current (active + on leave)" to **Removed / inactive**. Then click the ⋯ at the end of their row and choose **Restore (make active)**.

14 Making it official (Publish)

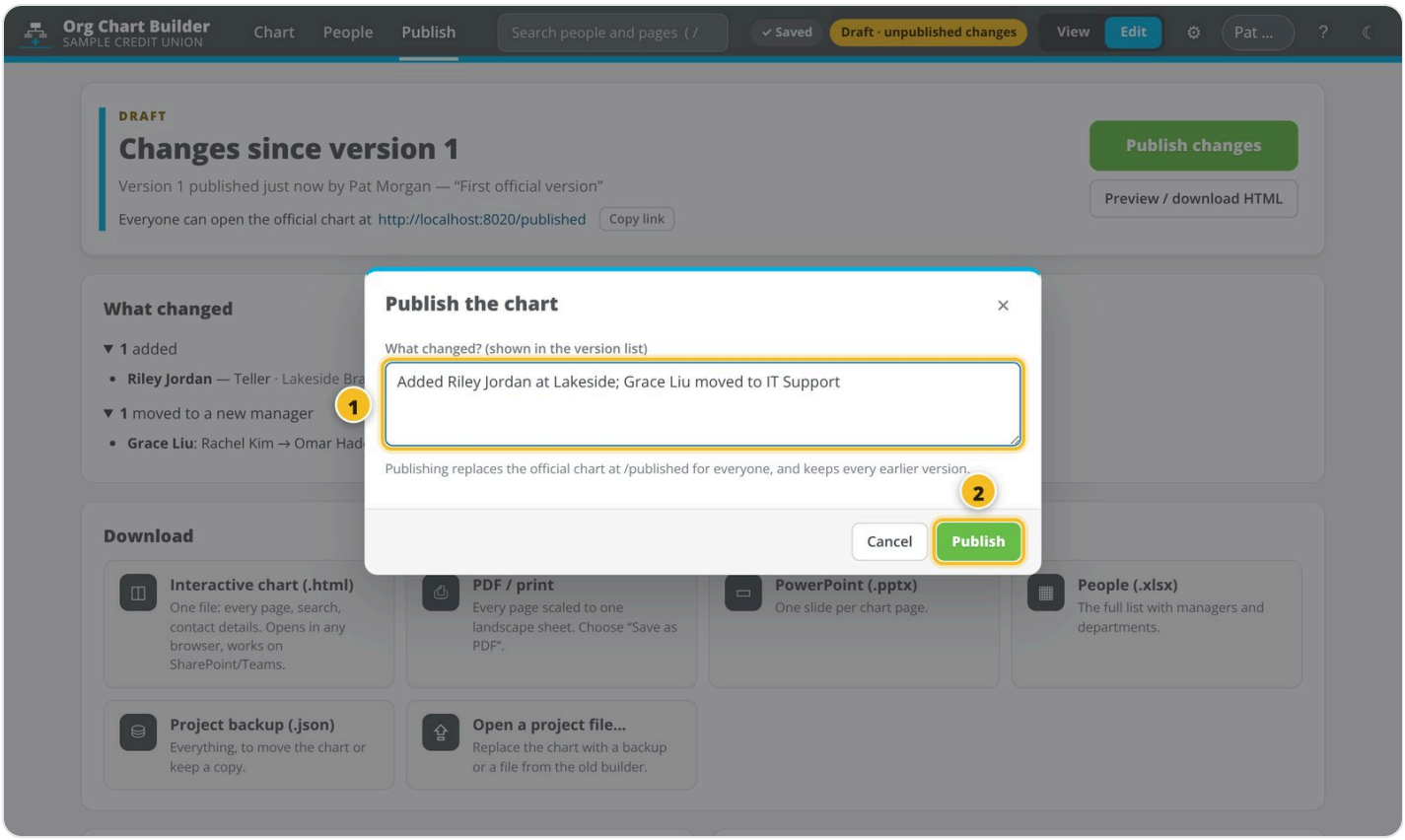
Your changes are a **draft** until you publish. While there are unpublished changes, the top of the screen shows a yellow **Draft · unpublished changes** label.

Publishing is like printing the “official copy”. Everyone who opens the official chart sees the new version. Only publish when the changes have been checked.

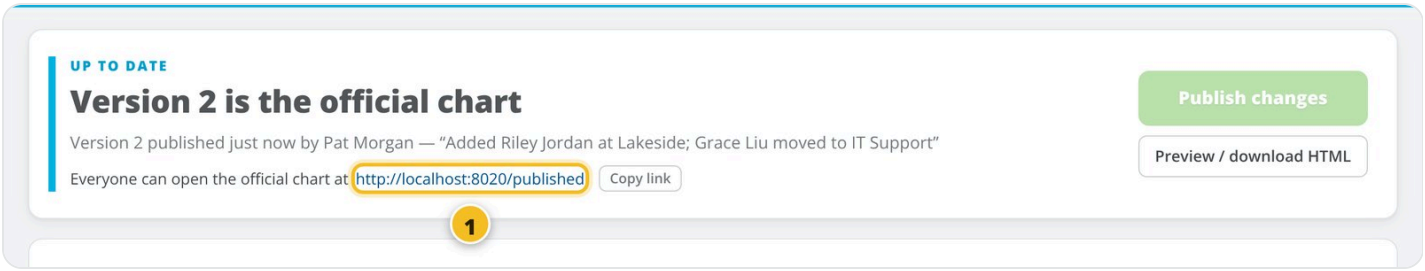
1. Click **Publish** at the top of the screen.
2. Read the **What changed** list (2). It shows exactly who was added, removed or moved since the last official version. Is it right?
3. Click the green **Publish changes** button (1).



4. Type a short note about what changed (1), for example *“New teller at Lakeside, Grace moved to IT Support”*.
5. Click **Publish** (2).

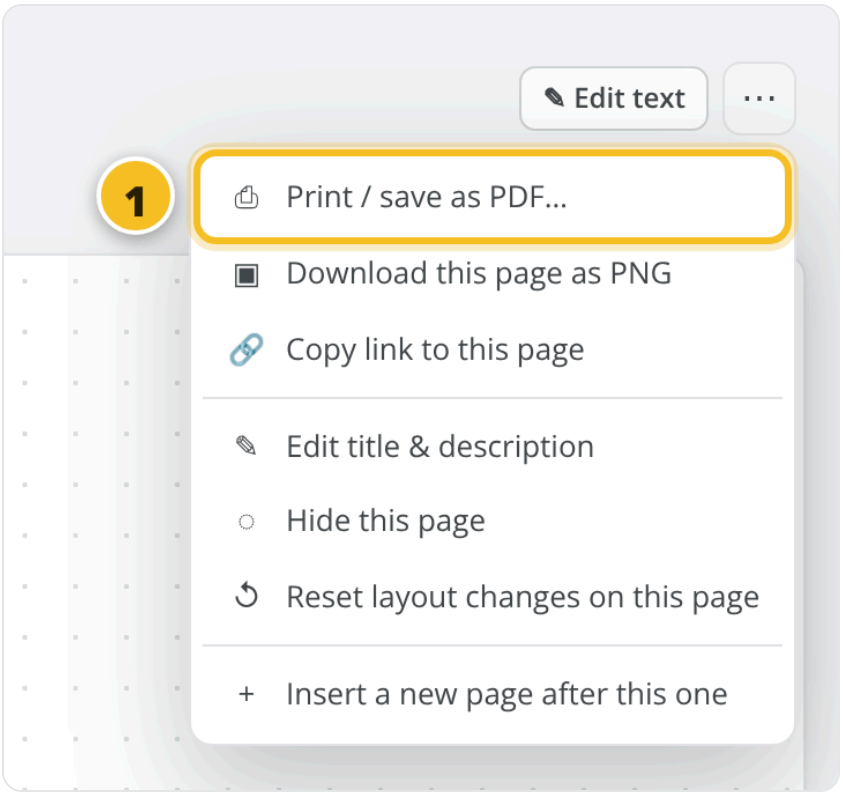


The top now says **"Version 2 is the official chart"**, and the label at the top turns green: **Published v2**.

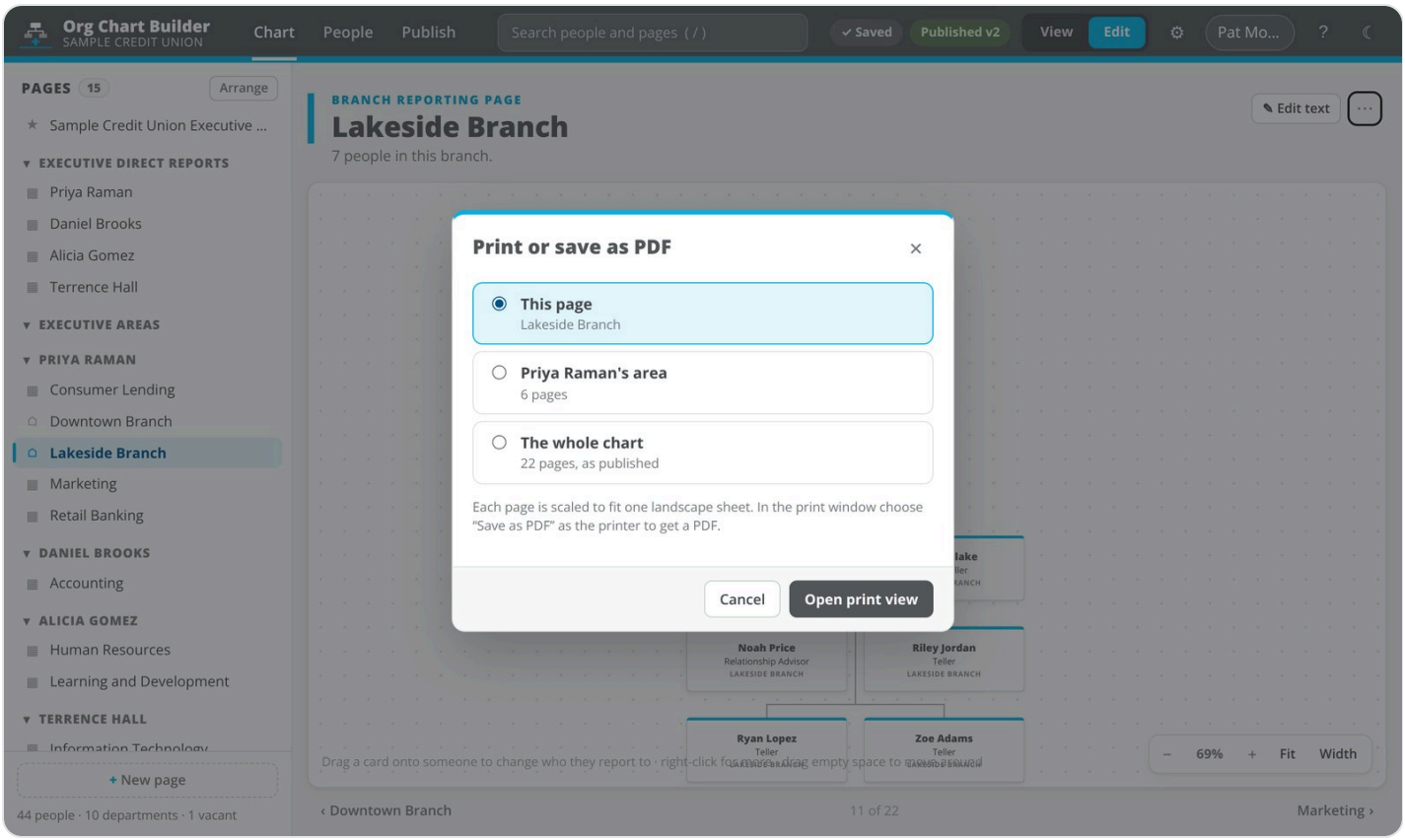


15 Printing or saving a PDF

1. Open the page you want to print.
2. Click the ⋯ button at the top right of the page, then **Print / save as PDF...** 1.



3. Choose what to print: **This page**, one executive's **area**, or **The whole chart**.
4. Click **Open print view**.



5 The print window opens. To print on paper, pick your printer and click **Print**.
To get a **PDF file**, change the **Destination** (or **Printer**) to **Save as PDF** and click **Save**.

Each chart page prints on its own sheet
sideways (landscape), sized to fit. Very big departments come out small, so for those you may prefer the PDF, because you can zoom in on it.

Other files you can get

On the **Publish** screen, under **Download**, you can also get a **PowerPoint** (one slide per page), an **Excel** list of everyone, and an **interactive chart** file that opens in any web browser.

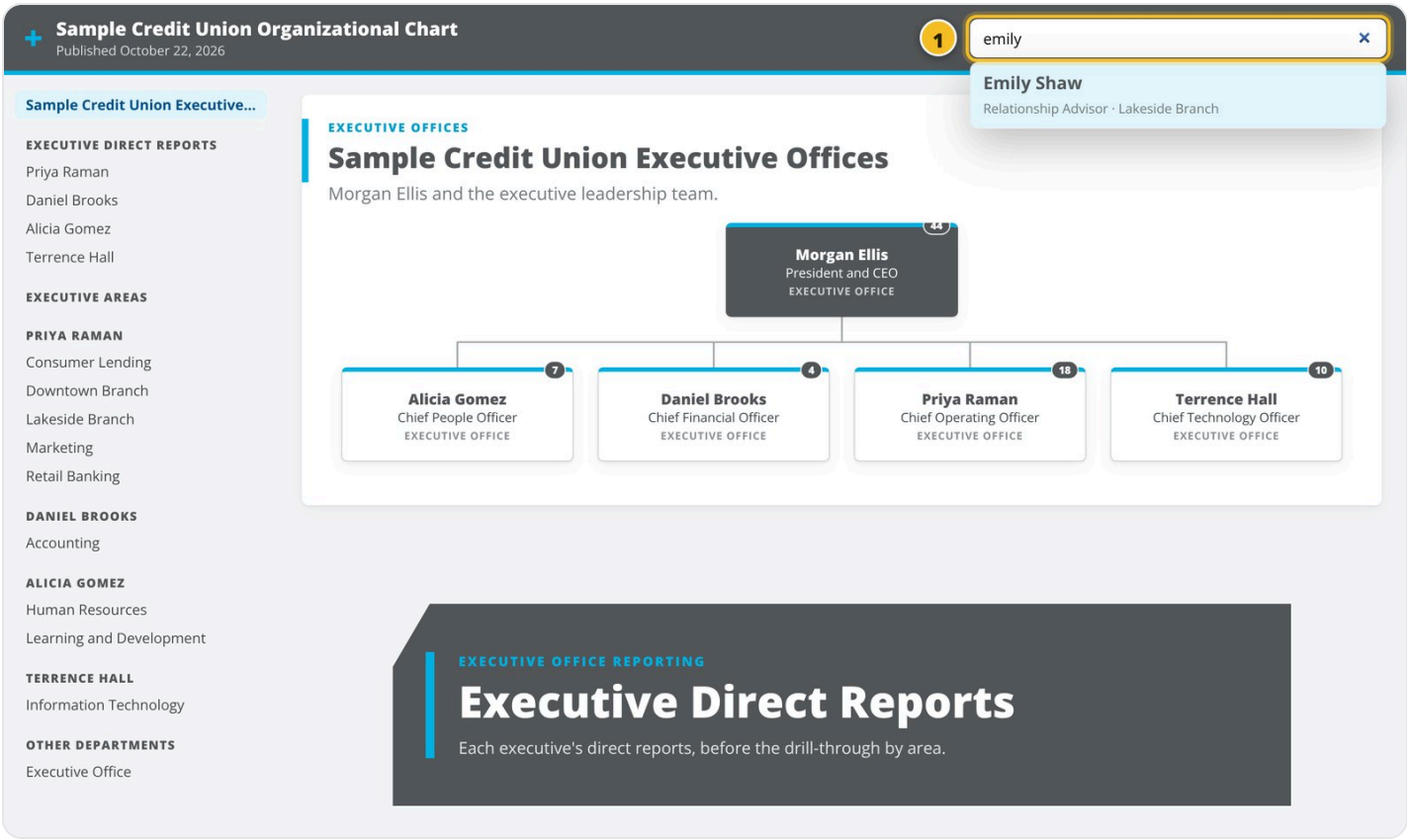
"DRAFT" on your printout?
That means there are changes that haven't been published yet. Publish first (section 14) if you want the official version.

16 Sharing the chart with everyone

People who only need to **look** at the chart don't need the Org Chart Builder at all.

1. Go to **Publish**. Near the top it says **“Everyone can open the official chart at …”**.
2. Click **Copy link** and paste it into an email or a Teams message.

Anyone who opens that link sees the latest **published** chart. They can search for a person 1 and click a card to see contact details. They **can't** change anything.

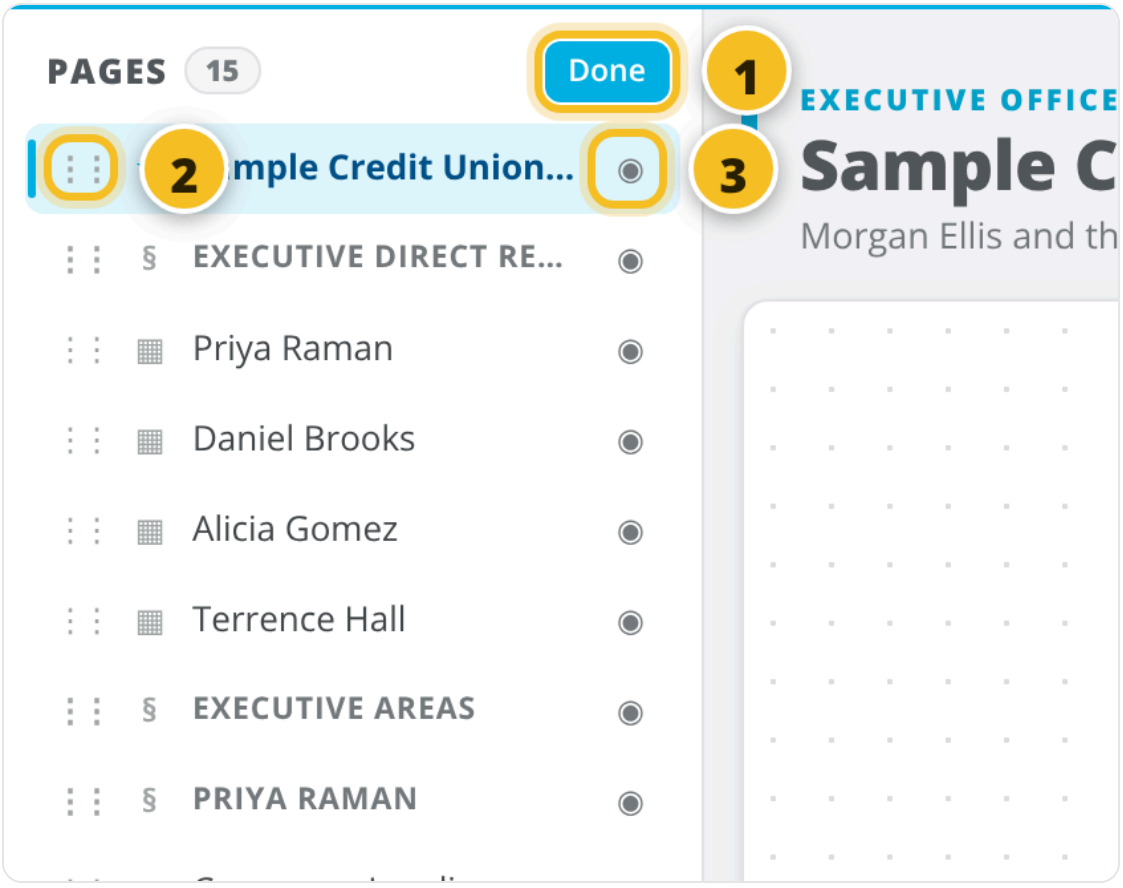


The link only works while the host computer is on and its black window is open (see section 2). For people outside the office network, send the PDF or the interactive chart file instead.

17 Rearranging or hiding pages (optional)

The pages are made for you automatically from who reports to whom. You don't have to touch them, but you can change their order.

1. Make sure **Edit** is on.
2. Click **Arrange** at the top of the page list (1).
3. To move a page, drag it by the dotted handle (2) to a new spot.
4. To hide a page from the official chart, click the round button (3) at the end of its row. Click it again to show it.
5. Click **Done** when you're finished.



To change a page's title, open the page and click **✎ Edit text** at its top right.

18 Something looks wrong? (Help)

What you see	What to do
I can't change anything. Nothing happens when I drag or right-click.	You're in **View** mode. Click **Edit** at the top right (section 7).
“This site can't be reached” or a blank window	The host computer's black window was closed, or the computer is off or asleep. On the host computer, double-click the Org Chart Builder icon. Everyone else: wait a minute, then press F5 to reload.
A red label at the top: “Offline · 2 unsaved”	The connection dropped for a moment. **Don't close the window.** Your changes are kept and are sent as soon as the connection is back. The label then changes to “✓ Saved”.
The chart is tiny, or I'm lost somewhere on the page	Click **Fit** in the bottom-right corner of the chart (section 5).
I made a change by mistake	Click **Undo** on the green message, or press Ctrl + Z (section 10).
I need yesterday's version back	Go to **Publish** and scroll down to **Snapshots** (automatic backups) or **Published versions**. Click the ⋯ next to the one you want, then **Restore...**. The current chart is backed up first, so this is safe. *Tip: tell your colleagues before you do this.*
Someone is on the wrong page or missing from a page	Pages are built from each person's **Department** and **Reports to**. Click the person and check those two boxes (section 8).
A message says “Updated with Pat's changes”	Nothing to do. A colleague changed something and your screen caught up.

The yellow label says “Draft · unpublished changes”	There are changes that aren't official yet. Publish when they're checked (section 14).
Where did my PDF / Excel / PowerPoint go?	Into your **Downloads** folder. Open File Explorer and click **Downloads** on the left.
The black window says “Python is not installed”	Ask your IT contact to install Python on the host computer. This is a one-time setup.

Still stuck? Click the **?** button at the top right of the Org Chart Builder for a short reminder, or contact your Org Chart coordinator.

19 One-page cheat sheet

Print this page and keep it next to your keyboard.

I want to…	How
Open the Org Chart Builder	Double-click the desktop icon. Host: leave the black window open.
Find someone	Type their name in **Search** (top), then click them.
See the whole page	Click **Fit** (bottom right of the chart).
Move around a big chart	Drag an empty spot, or scroll.
Make changes	Click **Edit** (top right). Changes save by themselves.
Change a title or name	Click the person, type in the panel on the right, press Enter.
Change someone's manager	Drag their card onto the new manager's card.
Add a person	Right-click the manager, then **Add a direct report…**
Add an open position	Right-click the manager, then **Add a vacant position under them…**
Fill an open position	Right-click the Vacant card, then **Fill this vacancy…**
Someone leaves	Right-click them, then **Remove…**, then keep the position as a vacancy.
Undo a mistake	**Undo** on the green message, or Ctrl + Z.
Make it official	**Publish** tab, then **Publish changes**, type a note, then **Publish**.
Print or make a PDF	⋯ (top right of a page), then **Print / save as PDF…**

Get the list in Excel	**People** tab, then **Export ▾**, then **Excel workbook**.
Share the chart	**Publish** tab, then **Copy link**, and paste it in an email.

Remember:
you can't break it. Everything can be undone, and the chart keeps backups.

Org Chart Builder · Step-by-step guide